



“The Dell India R&D Centre engineers are maintainers for three of the important Fedora packages.”

Jagadeesh R, senior manager,
OS and Hypervisor Engineering,
Dell India R&D Centre

and development of systems management software; and the development of customised enterprise solutions. This shift in ownership indicates the growth in maturity and stability of the management and technology teams in Bengaluru.

Q Does the Dell India R&D Centre handle consumer products as well?

RB: No, this centre focuses only on enterprise-related hardware, software, systems management and solutions engineering. The consumer products are handled by our design centre in Austin, Texas.

Q What are the roles and responsibilities of the Dell India R&D Centre?

RB: This centre has a variety of roles and responsibilities to deliver to various software programs:

- The operating system and hypervisor division is led by Jagadeesh, and they make sure that all Dell enterprise-class hardware runs smoothly with popularly available operating systems and hypervisors.
- The systems management group designs and develops applications and tools to monitor performance, and conduct systems diagnostic tests about the general health of the servers. For example, if a system is about to fail due to fluctuations in temperature caused by fan failure, the systems management software will take appropriate action to forewarn the systems administrator.

Systems management can be either in-band or out-of-band. The Dell India R&D Centre owns the design and is responsible for the development of an in-band product called ‘OpenManage’ that performs all activities including monitoring, deployment and change management

The Centre also delivers the connections to manage heterogeneous environments. Three years ago, Dell came up with the concept of out-of-band management using iDRAC, which is an enhanced version of embedded Linux ported on the motherboard. It acts as a remote access controller, and has a CPU and memory that is different from the host.

- The Dell India R&D Centre is also architecting and designing cutting-edge solutions to effectively manage virtual infrastructures.
- The Centre also works on cluster computing by connecting multiple boxes in various cloud environments. Apart from the above, the Dell India R&D Centre performs various testing activities, which are developed by other global teams at Taipei or Austin.
- Besides, documentation of all Dell products is done out of the Bengaluru centre, in over 30 languages. This includes technical documents of various products, and user manuals for our products.

Q How important is an independent software vendor (ISV) for Dell?

RB: ISVs are of importance to us at a global level, although in India, we have just started the initiative. Let's see how it goes. ISVs can contact us at TechnologyPartnerRegistrationRequest@Dell.com

Q Does Dell also take the help of its partners and ISVs for large-scale deployments?

RB: Yes, we work closely with Red Hat, Novell, Canonical, Microsoft, VMware and many such partners. Dell not only plays a significant role in the product development lifecycle of our partners, but also brings a lot of revenue benefits to our partners, in terms of licence and subscription sales as an OEM partner.

We also have global ISV programmes, under which multinational companies like SAP, Oracle, PeopleSoft, etc, partner with us. Even niche ISVs, which can make a considerable change to SMBs in India, can collaborate with us. We have recently started an ISV programme, under which any firm can be our ISV, provided it has created an interesting application that solves either a large or very specific problem set faced by our customers. We explore ways to collaborate, and we also undertake a study on how the solution behaves on Dell servers, storage systems and networks.